

Ananya Kotia

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Employment

Stanford University, Palo Alto, US
Assistant Professor of Finance, Stanford Graduate School of Business 2027-
Postdoctoral Fellowship, Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (SIEPR) 2026-27

India Data Lab Initiative  www.idli.dev
Founder and Director 2025-

Education

London School of Economics, London, UK 2026
PhD in Economics

University of Oxford, Oxford, UK 2015
MPhil Economics

University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK 2013
MA Economics

University of Delhi, Delhi, India 2011
BA (Honours) Economics

Working Papers

“When Competition Compels Change: Trade, Management, and Productivity”
Job Market Paper

“Meritocracy across Countries”, NBER Working Paper No. 32375.
(with Oriana Bandiera, Ilse Lindenlaub, Christian Moser, and Andrea Prat)
R&R, Econometrica

Work in Progress

1. **“Improving Tax Administration via AI: Randomized Evaluation of a Decision Support Tool”** (with Daron Acemoglu and Utkarsh Saxena)
2. **“Management in India”** (with Nick Bloom, Megha Patnaik, Mert Akan, and Janak Nabar)
3. **“AI and Judicial State Capacity in India”** (with Utkarsh Saxena)
4. **“How Much Do Firms Save? Financial Frictions and the Microeconomic Implications of the Euler Equation”**
5. **“Labor Market Frictions, the Organization of Labor, and Structural Change”** (with Chinmay Lohani and Utkarsh Saxena)

6. **“Aggregate Impacts of Command-and-Control Environmental Policy: Evidence from Court-Ordered Mining Bans in India”** (with Utkarsh Saxena and Henry Zhang)

Awards, Honors, and Fellowships

REStud North America Tour	2026
The Daniel Cohen Award, Paris School of Economics	2026
Top Finance Graduate Award	2026
Dartmouth International Economics PhD Fellowship	2023
LSE Economics Scholarship	2019
Mahindra Scholarship	2015
Inlaks Scholarship	2011
Cambridge Trusts Scholarship	2011

Teaching

<i>LSE</i>	EC307: Undergraduate-level Development Economics • TA to Professors Oriana Bandiera, Robin Burgess, 2020-21, 2021-22, 2023-24
<i>STEG</i>	Virtual Course on Graduate-level Heterogeneous Agent Macroeconomics • TA to Professor Benjamin Moll, 2021
<i>IZA/FCDO</i>	Online Development Economics Course for Sub-Saharan Africa • TA to Professors Oriana Bandiera and Robin Burgess, 2021

Presentations (* scheduled)

2026	NBER Summer Institute (DEV)*, Harvard/MIT Development Economics Seminar*, Princeton Development Economics Seminar*, World Bank Research Department-Macro, Trade, & Finance Seminar*, UCSD*, Penn State*, Michigan Trade Day*, Northwestern*, Rice Applied Economics Seminar*, CEPR Policy Forum (PSE), Empirical Management Conference (Stanford), Stanford GSB, University of Chicago (Department of Economics), Chicago Booth (x2), Northwestern Kellogg, Yale SOM, UT Austin, Manchester University
2025	NBER Summer Institute (Macro and Productivity), SED Annual Meeting, IGC/EGC Conference on Firms, Trade, and Development (Yale), CEPR IMO & ESF Joint Meetings (Bocconi), NEUDC (Tufts), Imperial College, 4th Workshop on Globalization and Workforce Composition (Paris Dauphine)
2024	UCL-IFS-LSE Development Economics Seminar, European Association of Labor Economists, Indian Statistical Institute
2023	Dartmouth College (x2)

Professional Activities

Refereeing:

American Economic Review, Econometrica, Review of Economic Studies, Economic Journal, U.S. National Science Foundation

Service:

Co-Organizer, LSE Queer Conf 2024, 2025. UK's first conference for queer economics PhD students.

Research Grants

"Artificial Intelligence and Judicial State Capacity.", with Utkarsh Saxena. Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics

"Trade and Management", Private Enterprise Development in Low-Income Countries, PEDL.

"Artificial Intelligence and Judicial State Capacity", with Utkarsh Saxena. International Growth Center, IGC, Open Philanthropy.

"Bridging Data Gaps: A Platform for Harmonized Indian Firm/Household Microdata". IGC.

"How Much Do Firms Save? Microeconomic Implications of the Euler Equation." Structural Transformation and Economic Growth, STEG.

"Digitizing Historical Plant Level Panel Data on Labor Outcomes", with Utkarsh Saxena. IZA-FCDO Program on Growth and Labor Markets in Low-Income Countries, PEDL, and IGC.

"UK's first conference for Queer PhD students in Economics", with Pol Simpson. Suntory and Toyota International Centres for Economics (STICERD) and LSE Department of Economics.

"Aggregate Impacts of Command-and-Control Environmental Policy" with Utkarsh Saxena, Henry Zhang, STICERD, EU Horizon 2020, PEDL, George and Obie Shultz Fund.

"Trade Liberalization and Misallocation", IGC.

"Labor Market Frictions, the Organization of Labor, and Structural Change", with Chinmay Lohani and Utkarsh Saxena. STEG.

"FDI and Firm Expansion". Ministry of Corporate Affairs, Government of India.

Other Employment

2021-22 Research Assistant to Professor Oriana Bandiera, LSE

2020-22 Consultant, South Asia Chief Economist's Office, World Bank, Washington D.C.

2017-19 Predoctoral Fellow with Professor Michael Greenstone, University of Chicago

2016-17 Economist, Office of the Chief Economic Advisor, Ministry of Finance, Government of India

2015-16 Consultant, Fiscal Rules Review Committee, Ministry of Finance, Government of India

2015 Graduate Summer Intern, International Monetary Fund, Washington D.C.

Research Interests

Finance, Trade, Development